

THOR

The Asgardian God of Thunder

THOR

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Thor Odinson (alias Donald Blake, Eric Masterson, Jake Olson)

OCCUPATION

God of Thunder

BASE

Asgard

HEIGHT

6 ft 6 in

WEIGHT

640 lbs

EYES

Blue

HAIR

Blond

FIRST APPEARANCE

Journey Into Mystery Vol. 1 #83

(August 1962)

POWERS

Enhanced strength, near-invulnerability, longevity, and vast magical abilities provided by the Odinson. Wields the unbreakable hammer of Mjolnir which can open interdimensional portals, permit flight, channel storms, and fire energy blasts.

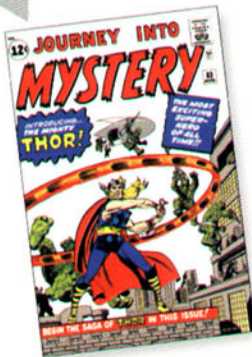
ALLIES/FOES

ALLIES The Avengers, Beta Ray Thor, Sif, Warriors Three

FOES Loki, Surtur, the Enchantress, the Absorbing Man

ISSUE #1

In Journey into Mystery, Thor leads a double life as the Thunder God and the mortal man Donald Blake. Later, Thor dropped the Blake identity.



Thor was the God of Thunder, the beloved champion of Asgard (see GODS OF ASGARD) and a figure of worship among the ancient Norse. He loved his people so much that he triggered their destruction in the end battle of Ragnarok, finally breaking a repeating cycle of futility. Thor was born to Odin, the ruler (sky-father) of Asgard, and Gaea, the mother goddess of Earth (a place known to the Asgardians as Midgard).

Thor could transport himself to Midgard via Asgard's rainbow bridge, or by using the powers of his hammer Mjolnir.

EARLY LIFE

Groomed to assume his father's throne, Thor grew up with his best friend Balder and his first love, Sif. But Thor's half-brother Loki hated him, and schemed to become ruler of Asgard himself.

When Thor proved himself worthy of carrying the uru hammer Mjolnir, he took up the identity as the Thunder God. Thor mingled with his Earthly worshippers throughout the 9th century, leading Vikings into battle. He later abandoned his followers after several of them butchered a Christian monastery. Over the succeeding centuries he spent most of his time in Asgard,



Originally, Thor transformed from Donald Blake to the Thunder God by striking a simple wooden staff on the ground.

venturing to Earth to battle Loki in the Old West and mistakenly becoming a pawn of the Nazis during World War II.

Deciding that his son needed to learn humility before assuming the title of sky-father, Odin exiled Thor to Earth. There, the Thunder God believed himself to be the mortal doctor Donald Blake, and walked with the aid of a



As one of the core members of the Avengers, Thor defeated the robot Ultron and crushed countless other threats to humanity.

wooden cane. When he struck the cane on the ground it transformed into Mjolnir, and Thor regained his powers and all memories of his life on Asgard. For years, he lived a dual identity as Thor and Blake, battling threats such as the RADIOACTIVE MAN and the ABSORBING

MAN. Loki sought to entrap Thor by drawing him into conflict with the HULK, but only succeeded in uniting a group of heroes that would become the Avengers. Thor became a founding member of the team, and fought alongside such heroes as CAPTAIN AMERICA, IRON MAN, and HERCULES. Few beings ever bested Thor in combat, but the alien BETA RAY

BILL defeated the Thunder God and proved worthy of wielding the hammer of Mjolnir.

Impressed, Odin forged a new hammer, Stormbreaker, for Bill to wield. Thor gave up his Blake alter ego at this time, briefly trying out a new identity as construction worker Sigurd Jarson. New trials continued to vex Thor—his father Odin

STORMY TIMES

A second incarnation of the Thunder God appeared when Thor merged his spirit with Earth architect Eric Masterson. Thor entered temporary exile for apparently killing Loki, and Masterson carried on, posing as Thor while wielding the hammer of Mjolnir. Masterson later received the identity of Thunderstrike, before perishing in battle against the Egyptian god Seth and overcoming a curse laid upon Masterson by the weapon of Bloodaxe. Thor subsequently assumed the civilian identity of dead EMS worker Jake Olson, though he soon gave this up and let a resurrected Olson continue his life. Eric Masterson's son, Kevin, later took up the role of Thunderstrike in a possible future timeline also inhabited by Spider-Girl.

Thor and Thunderstrike unite their mystical hammers to unleash even greater power. Thor, who considered Eric Masterson one of the most noble mortals he had ever encountered, greatly mourned his death.



seemingly perished in combat against the fire demon Surtur, and Thor refused the throne, the honor passing to Balder. Thor then suffered terrible torment when a curse rendered him incapable of death. Wounds nearly disintegrated his body until the spell was reversed.

RAGNAROK

The events that led to the end of Asgard began with the true death of Odin, killed battling Surtur. Thor took up the mantle of rulership and became empowered with the mystical Odinson. Wishing to take a more direct role over earthly affairs, Thor moved Asgard to Earth and transformed the planet into a dictatorship that endured for two hundred years. At last, realizing the error of his actions, he unwound the previous two centuries through time travel.

Loki enlisted Surtur to forge new weapons comparable in power to Mjolnir. He rallied his followers and conquered Asgard. Thor, realizing that Loki's actions presaged the final conflagration of Ragnarok, followed the Odinson on a spiritual journey. The Thunder God uncovered the truth of the Ragnarok cycle—its endless loop of creation and rebirth had been orchestrated by the

godlike Those Who Sit Above in Shadow for their amusement. Unwilling to endure his people's dishonor through yet another cycle, Thor severed the tapestry that wove the reality of Asgard's dimension, wiping himself and Asgard from existence.

Desperate for Thor's power during the Civil War, MR. FANTASTIC and HANK PYM created a



Ragnarok, the twilight of the gods, spelled an end to all of the five races of the dimension of Asgard.

biomechanical Thor clone. It proved hard to control and killed GIANT-MAN (Bill Foster). It later attacked the Fifty State Initiative's headquarters at Camp Hammond.

Later, in the void of the afterlife, Thor reunited with his old alter ego Donald Blake and returned to Earth, rebuilding Asgard on an island floating in the sky over Oklahoma. He then set out to find the other gods, who now lived unknowingly as mortals, and restore them to their rightful places. He was banished from Asgard for killing his grandfather Bor in battle.

DW, MF

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• The Mighty Thor #337

Beta Ray Bill explodes into action as a rival, and later an ally, of the Thunder God.

• Thor: Son of Asgard #1-12

This limited series explores the early adventures of a young Balder the Brave, Sif, and Thor.

• The Mighty Thor #582-588

It's Ragnarok, the Asgardian apocalypse, and the long-running series comes to an end with the total destruction of Asgard and all who live there.



Beta Ray Bill proved he was able to fight alongside the Asgardians, and became Beta Ray Thor.